Exercise: 19

Types of Inflorescence

Aim: To study and identify the types of inflorescence

Principle: Group of flowers arising from a branched or unbranched axis with a definite pattern. Inflorescences may also have classified based on branching, number and arrangement of flowers, and some specialized structures. They are inderterminate inflorescence, determinate inflorescence, mixed inflorescence, special inflorescence. Function of inflorescence is to display the flowers for effective pollination and facilitate seed dispersal.

Requirements: Fresh inflorescence of *Mangifera*, Neem (Panicle), *Caesalpinia* (Corymb), *Jasminum* (Simple dichasium) *Nerium* (Polychasial Cyme). / Photograph/ picture.

Diagnostic features:

1. Panicle

- A branched raceme is called panicle. It is also called compound raceme or raceme of racemes.
- Example: *Mangifera, Neem*.

2. Corymb

- In corymb inflorescence the shorter pedicellate flowers at the top and longer pedicellate flowers at the bottom.
- All flowers appear at the same level to form convex or flat topped racemose inflorescence.
- Example: *Caesalpinia*.

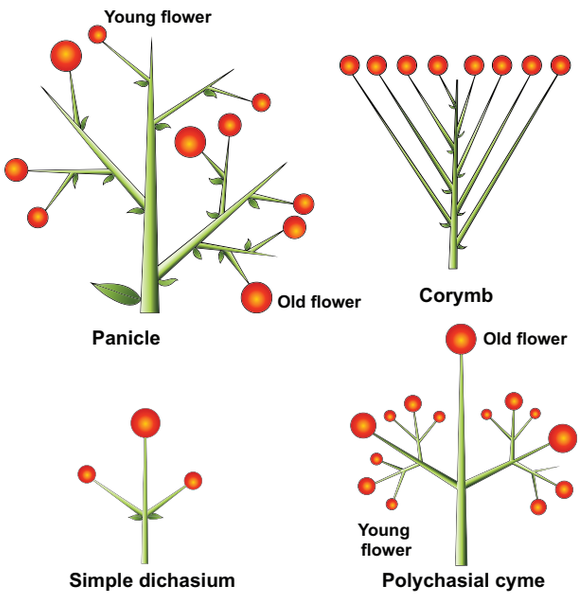


Figure 19 : Types of Inflorescence (Diagrammatic representation)

3. Simple dichasium (Biparous)

- A central axis ends in a terminal flower; further grows is produced by two lateral buds.
- Each cymose unit consists of three flowers of which central one is old one.
- Example: *Jasminum*

4. Polychasial cyme

- In central axis ends with a flower. The lateral axes branches repeatedly.
- Example: *Nerium*.

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